

Rock cycle

Rocks go through many changes over time. These are caused by different processes, such as heating, cooling, and weathering. The sequence of changes is called the rock cycle.

Cooling

When melted rock cools and hardens, it forms igneous rock. This can happen after a volcanic eruption or underground.

Igneous rock

Uplift

Metamorphic rock is forced upwards slowly by pressure and the movement of Earth's crust to form mountains.

Heat and pressure

Some sedimentary rock is dragged down into the Earth's mantle, where pressure and heat changes the rock into metamorphic rock.

Metamorphic rock

Melting

In the heat, some rocks melt into liquid, called magma. Pressure can force magma out of the ground.